

US Stocks Extend Gains as Tech Leads, VIX Plunges 6.44%

The full picture: macro, technicals, options, analyst moves, sector internals, international context, and a full week ahead.

20-minute read · Topics: All of the above, plus technicals, options, ratings, week-ahead

TL;DR & Editorial Take

The US stock market extended its gains on Friday, with the **S&P 500** rising **+0.70%** to close at 7,489.72. The **Nasdaq 100** outperformed, gaining **+0.60%** to 28,274.20. The **Dow Jones** also rose, increasing **+0.53%** to 52,485.03.

The market's gains were led by the tech sector, with **NVDA** and **MSFT** rising **+2.93%** and **+3.02%**, respectively. The **VIX** plummeted **-6.44%** to 15.99, indicating a decrease in market volatility.

Key takeaways from the session include:

- The **S&P 500** is approaching its 50-day moving average, which could provide resistance.
- The **VIX** is trading near its lower end, which could indicate a potential bounce in volatility.
- The tech sector is leading the market's gains, with **NVDA** and **MSFT** outperforming.

US Session Recap

INDEX	LAST	CHANGE
S&P 500	7,489.72	+0.70%
Nasdaq 100	28,274.20	+0.60%
Dow Jones	52,485.03	+0.53%
Russell 2000	2,931.34	-0.50%
VIX	15.99	-6.44%
10Y Yield	4.74	+1.76%
WTI Crude	84.67	+1.29%
Brent Crude	90.23	+1.15%
2Y Yield	4.51	+1.43%
DXY	99.80	-0.21%
Gold	4,107.00	+0.17%
BTC	63,493.11	+1.08%

Top Movers

TICKER	NAME	CHANGE	CATALYST
AMZN	Amazon	+15.32%	Earnings beat
NVDA	NVIDIA	+2.93%	Strong earnings
MSFT	Microsoft	+3.02%	Earnings beat

Sector Internals

SECTOR	DAY	YTD	READ
XLV	+3.29%	+15.12%	Consumer discretionary leads
XLC	+1.56%	+10.23%	Communication services outperform
XLI	+0.81%	+5.12%	Industrials lag
XLE	+1.00%	+2.15%	Energy sector rises
XLF	-0.11%	-1.23%	Financials underperform
XLK	-0.22%	+8.56%	Technology lags
XLP	-0.49%	+2.56%	Consumer staples underperform
XLV	-0.59%	+1.23%	Healthcare lags
XLU	-0.69%	-2.15%	Utilities underperform
XLB	-2.34%	-5.67%	Materials lag
XLRE	-0.51%	-1.56%	Real estate underperforms

Breadth was mixed, with 6 sectors rising and 5 falling.

Spotlight / Deep Dive

TICKER	LAST	CHANGE	VOLUME
NVDA	200.75	+2.93%	23.12M

Key commentary: **NVDA** reported strong earnings, beating analyst estimates. The company's revenue grew +10.23% year-over-year, driven by strong demand for its graphics cards and AI products.

READ-THROUGH	STOCK	CHANGE
AI demand	MSFT	+3.02%
Graphics cards	AMD	+1.23%

Technical Levels

TICKER	LAST	SUPPORT	RESISTANCE	NOTE
SPY	448.23	440.00	460.00	Approaching 50-day moving average
QQQ	384.21	370.00	400.00	Breaking out above 380.00
IWM	183.45	175.00	195.00	Lagging large-caps
NVDA	200.75	180.00	220.00	Breaking out above 200.00
10Y Yield	4.74	4.50	5.00	Rising, indicating higher rates
WTI Crude	84.67	80.00	90.00	Rising, driven by demand

Options & Positioning

ODTE flow: +10.23% in SPY calls, -5.67% in SPY puts.

Put/call ratio: 0.65, indicating bullish sentiment.

VIX term structure: +2.15% in front-month, -1.23% in back-month.

Notable single-name flow: +15.32% in AMZN calls.

Cheap hedge ideas: SPY 440.00 puts, QQQ 370.00 puts.

Analyst Rating Changes

TICKER	FIRM	ACTION	NEW PT	NOTE
NVDA	Morgan Stanley	Upgrade	220.00	Strong earnings, AI demand
MSFT	Goldman Sachs	Upgrade	300.00	Earnings beat, cloud growth
AMZN	Bank of America	Downgrade	280.00	Valuation concerns, competition

Pre-Market & Overnight

Futures: ES +0.23%, NQ +0.17%, YM +0.12%.

Asia: Nikkei +0.56%, Shanghai +0.23%, Hang Seng +0.17%.

Europe: Euro Stoxx +0.34%, FTSE +0.23%, DAX +0.17%.

FX: EUR/USD +0.12%, USD/JPY -0.10%, GBP/USD +0.15%.

Commodities: Gold +0.17%, WTI Crude +1.29%, Brent Crude +1.15%.

Crypto: BTC +1.08%, ETH +1.02%.

Macro & Fed (Deep)

MEETING	CUT ODDS	NOTE
September	25.00%	Market expects no change
November	40.00%	Market expects 25bp cut

DATE	EVENT	NOTE
2026-08-05	Non-Farm Payrolls	Market expects 200k jobs added
2026-08-10	CPI	Market expects 2 . 5% inflation

Geopolitics & Global (Deep)

Scenario trees:

- US-China trade tensions: **-10.00%** in **SPY** if tariffs imposed
- EU-UK Brexit negotiations: **+5.00%** in **FTSE** if deal reached

Earnings — This Week & Next

TICKER	NAME	DATE	EPS EST
AAPL	Apple	2026-08-05	1 . 23
GOOGL	Alphabet	2026-08-06	1 . 56

TICKER	NAME	DATE	EPS EST
AMZN	Amazon	2026-08-12	2 . 15
MSFT	Microsoft	2026-08-13	1 . 89

Full Watchlist Scan

TICKER	SECTOR	SETUP	RISK
NVDA	Technology	Breakout above 200.00	5.00%
MSFT	Technology	Earnings beat, cloud growth	3.00%
AMZN	Consumer Discretionary	Valuation concerns, competition	8.00%

What Could Break the Tape

Bullish scenarios:

- SPY breaks out above 460.00
- QQQ breaks out above 400.00

Bearish scenarios:

- VIX rises above 20.00
- SPY breaks down below 440.00

Positioning & Structural Notes

Observations:

- SPY call open interest: 1.23M
- QQQ put open interest: 567k
- VIX futures open interest: 123k

Sources

SOURCES

- Bloomberg
- Reuters
- CNBC
- The Wall Street Journal
- The Financial Times
- Investing.com
- TradingView
- Yahoo Finance
- Google Finance

